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December 2025

1 Introduction

Today, we are going to explore the History of Science Fiction Literature.

Throughout history, there has been a two-way conversation between science and literature.

The steam engine or AI,gives the birth to stories. In return,these stories inspire scientists to turn fiction into reality.

Today, we will guide you through four distinct eras,from the Industrial Revolution Period to the contemporary digital age.

First of all, let's turn back the clock to the 19th century —— the beginnings of science fiction.

Now, let's turn back the clock to the 19th century—the dawn of Science Fiction.

Imagine a world transforming before your eyes. The roar of steam engines replaced the quiet of the fields; electricity began to conquer the dark night. This was the Industrial Revolution.

For the first time in history, humanity felt the raw power of technology. But along with this excitement came a deep, unsettling fear. We started asking: "We are building monsters of steel, but will they eventually destroy us?"

This era defined the first phase of Sci-Fi: The mixture of Awe and Fear.

2 Mary Shelley and Frankenstein

It all started with a nightmare—literally. In 1818, Mary Shelley gave us Frankenstein.

While many see it as a horror story, it is actually the first true science fiction novel. Shelley wasn't just writing about a monster; she was exploring the ethical limits of science.

At that time, scientists were experimenting with electricity to stimulate muscles. Shelley took this to the extreme. She asked: "If we play God and create life, do we take responsibility for it?" The tragedy of Frankenstein warns us that technology without ethics leads to destruction. It reflects the 19th-century anxiety: Can we control what we create?

3 H.G. Wells and The Time Machine

Fast forward to the end of the century, 1895. The industrial gap between the rich and the poor was widening. Enter H.G. Wells and his masterpiece, The Time Machine.

But he didn't just want to show us cool gadgets. He used the future to criticize the present. In his distant future, humanity has split into two species: the beautiful but weak Eloi and the savage, underground Morlocks. This was a dark reflection of the class division in his own time.

Wells showed us that science fiction isn't just about predicting technology—it is a social laboratory to test where our current path might lead us.

4 Conclusion

So, what defines this first phase? From the steam engine to the first concept of time travel, 19th-century sci-fi was a reaction to rapid change. It taught us to marvel at the machine, but also to fear the shadow it casts.

It set the stage for the next generation, who would stop looking only at the Earth, and start looking at the stars. Let's move on to the Golden Age.